

Project Outline: IT Incident Management & Escalation - UB Key Login Issue

Project Title: IT Incident Management: Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Device Login Issue & Escalation

1. The Problem:

* **User Reported Issue:** A user at the airport was unable to log in to their work computer, specifically indicating an issue with their UB key (likely referring to a YubiKey or similar hardware security token used for multi-factor authentication). This prevented them from accessing their workstation and performing their duties.

2. Your Diagnosis & Action:

* **Initial Understanding:** Based on the user's description, I immediately recognized this as an issue related to multi-factor authentication (MFA) hardware/software, critical for secure access.

* **Scope Assessment:** Due to my role as an intern, I had limited administrative access and privileges within the Active Directory or identity management systems that manage UB key provisioning and user accounts. This meant I couldn't directly diagnose or rectify the underlying cause (e.g., key not provisioned, key malfunction, account lockout related to MFA).

* **Decision to Escalate:** Recognizing these limitations, I determined that the issue required higher-level permissions and specialized knowledge.

* **Action Taken:** I promptly informed the user of my limited access and escalated the issue to a Senior IT Analyst. I provided them with all the details the user had given me, ensuring a smooth handover.

3. The Solution (by Senior IT/Other Dept.):

* **Resolution Pathway:** The Senior IT Analyst, possessing the necessary elevated permissions and tools, took ownership of the case. They directed the user to another specialized IT department (likely Identity & Access Management or a dedicated security team).

* **Outcome of Resolution:** This other IT department had the specific authority and resources to troubleshoot the UB key, re-provision it, or resolve any related account access issues, ultimately allowing the user to gain access to their work computer.

4. Outcome & Impact:

* **Problem Resolution:** While not directly resolved by me, the user's critical login issue was successfully addressed through proper escalation channels.

* **Service Continuity:** My quick assessment and effective escalation ensured that the user was directed to the correct resource without unnecessary delays, contributing to their prompt return to productivity.

* **Learning Experience:** This incident reinforced the importance of understanding my role's scope and the established escalation procedures within a larger IT environment.

5. Skills Demonstrated:

- * Incident Triage & Initial Assessment: Quickly understanding the nature of the login problem and its link to MFA.
- * Scope Management: Accurately identifying the boundaries of my access and capabilities as an intern.
- * Effective Escalation: Clearly communicating the issue and handing it off to the appropriate senior personnel.
- * Communication Skills: Interacting professionally with the user and the Senior IT Analyst.
- * Understanding of IT Processes: Familiarity with the chain of command and specialized IT departments (e.g., identity management).
- * Security Awareness: Recognition of multi-factor authentication as a critical security component.